

CENTRAL BOARD OF SECONDARY EDUCATION — PRACTICE EXAMINATION**CLASS IX • SOCIAL SCIENCE (SUBJECT CODE: 087) • ACADEMIC SESSION 2026-27****SET F — RAPID FIRE SPEED TEST (30 MINS)****CHAPTER 06: DEMOCRACY****TIME ALLOWED: 30 MINUTES****MAXIMUM MARKS: 25 MARKS****SERIES: CBS-IX-SST-SET-F-06****Student's Name:** _____**Roll No.:** _____**Class & Section:** Class IX - _____**Date of Exam:** _____**Invigilator's Sign:** _____**General Instructions (SET F - Rapid Fire Speed Test):**

1. The question paper comprises **25 Rapid Fire Multiple Choice Questions** of **1 mark each**.
2. Designed for **Rapid Recall & High-Speed Accuracy**: Recommended target time is **30 Minutes**.
3. All questions are compulsory. There is no negative marking.
4. Darken the corresponding bubble on the **OMR Sheet** completely using a blue/black ballpoint pen.

⚡ SPEED CHALLENGE INSTRUCTIONS: Answer promptly without looking at notes. Test your instant recall of historical milestones, geographic terms, constitutional provisions, and core economic laws!

Q.1 Who famously defined democracy as 'government of the people, by the people, for the people'?

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|-----------------------|---------------------|
| (A) Winston Churchill | (B) Abraham Lincoln |
| (C) Nelson Mandela | (D) Mahatma Gandhi |

Q.2 What is the primary defining feature that distinguishes a democracy from a monarchy or dictatorship?

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|---|--|
| (A) Rulers are born into royal families | (B) Rulers are elected by the citizens and can be replaced through regular competitive elections |
| (C) The military general commands the country's television stations | (D) Judges have absolute power to rule without parliaments |

Q.3 Which political party won every presidential election in Mexico between 1930 and 2000 through systemic state manipulation?

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|---------------------------------|---|
| (A) National Action Party (PAN) | (B) Institutional Revolutionary Party (PRI) |
| (C) Communist Party of Mexico | (D) Socialist Workers Party |

Q.4 In Pakistan, who led a military coup d'état in 1999 and issued the Legal Framework Order in 2002?

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|----------------|------------------------------|
| (A) Zia-ul-Haq | (B) General Pervez Musharraf |
| (C) Ayub Khan | (D) Benazir Bhutto |

Q.5 In which country must all candidates contesting parliamentary elections receive prior approval from the ruling Communist Party?

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|-------------------|--------------------|
| (A) India | (B) China |
| (C) United States | (D) United Kingdom |

Q.6 Prior to 2015, which large demographic group was entirely excluded from exercising the right to vote in Saudi Arabia?

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|---------------------------|---------------|
| (A) All men over 60 | (B) Women |
| (C) University professors | (D) Merchants |

Q.7 In Fiji's historical electoral system, whose vote carried greater mathematical weight in electing representatives?

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|--------------------------|--------------------------------|
| (A) Indo-Fijian citizens | (B) Indigenous Fijian citizens |
| (C) Foreign tourists | (D) Minority language speakers |

Q.8 The democratic canon of 'one person, one vote, one value' means:

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|--|--|
| (A) Every citizen must cast five votes in every election | (B) Every citizen possesses one vote, and every vote carries identical mathematical weight |
| (C) Votes are counted only for citizens who pay property taxes | (D) The wealthiest citizen's vote counts ten times more |

Q.9 Which African nation was ruled by Robert Mugabe and his party ZANU-PF through state coercion and judicial intimidation?

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|-------------|--------------|
| (A) Kenya | (B) Zimbabwe |
| (C) Nigeria | (D) Ghana |

Q.10 According to economist Amartya Sen, why did independent democratic India avoid mass famines while China suffered 30 million deaths in 1958–61?

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|--|--|
| (A) India had ten times more food grain than China | (B) Democratic accountability, an independent free press, and competitive elections forced Indian leaders to respond swiftly to crop shortages |
| (C) India imported food from outer space | (D) China had zero agricultural farmland |

Q.11 What is an argument often raised by critics AGAINST democracy?

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|---|---|
| (A) Democracy makes citizens too dignified | (B) Frequent changes in political leadership can lead to instability and slow decision-making from consultation |
| (C) Democracy prevents all government corruption completely | (D) Democracies never hold any public debates |

Q.12 What is a primary argument in FAVOR of democracy?

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| (A) It guarantees that leaders will never make any mistakes | (B) It offers a peaceful, constitutional mechanism to resolve conflicts among diverse groups and allows citizens to correct errors |
| (C) It gives absolute sovereign power to military generals | (D) It eliminates all public taxes |

Q.13 A system where all citizens assemble together in person to vote directly on every law and policy is known as:

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|------------------------------|----------------------|
| (A) Representative democracy | (B) Direct democracy |
| (C) Constitutional monarchy | (D) Oligarchy |

Q.14 Why do modern continental nation-states like India and the USA practice REPRESENTATIVE democracy rather than direct democracy?

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|---|---|
| (A) Modern populations and geographic scale make it physically impossible for all citizens to sit together daily to decide policies | (B) Citizens are legally forbidden from learning about politics |
| (C) There are no buildings large enough to hold ten people | (D) Because elections are held only once every thousand years |

Q.15 In his final address to the Constituent Assembly, Dr. B. R. Ambedkar warned that 'Bhakti' (hero-worship) in politics leads to:

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|------------------------------------|---|
| (A) Complete economic equality | (B) Degradation and eventual dictatorship |
| (C) Rapid technological innovation | (D) Universal happiness |

Q.16 Which article of the Indian Constitution was termed the 'heart and soul of the Constitution' by Dr. B. R. Ambedkar?

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|----------------|---|
| (A) Article 14 | (B) Article 19 |
| (C) Article 21 | (D) Article 32 (Right to Constitutional Remedies) |

Q.17 A democratic government cannot act arbitrarily after winning an election because it is bounded by:

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|--|--|
| (A) Orders from foreign superpowers | (B) Constitutional law, separation of powers, and respect for citizen fundamental rights |
| (C) The personal whims of the ruling monarch | (D) Secret military directives |

Q.18 In Estonia, which linguistic minority faced severe legal hurdles in acquiring citizenship and voting rights after 1991?

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|----------------------|-----------------------------|
| (A) German minority | (B) Ethnic Russian minority |
| (C) Finnish minority | (D) Swedish minority |

Q.19 Which European nation regularly utilizes popular citizen referendums and initiatives as direct democratic instruments?

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|--------------------|-----------------|
| (A) United Kingdom | (B) Switzerland |
| (C) France | (D) Germany |

Q.20 How does democracy protect the rights of minority communities against 'tyranny of the majority'?

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|--|---|
| (A) By banning minorities from living in the country | (B) By enshrining Fundamental Rights and judicial review that no legislative majority can arbitrarily violate |
| (C) By giving every minority citizen a private army | (D) By canceling all national elections |

Q.21 Which military dictator ruled Chile following the violent overthrow of President Salvador Allende in 1973?

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|------------------------------|------------------|
| (A) General Augusto Pinochet | (B) Fidel Castro |
| (C) Hugo Chavez | (D) Che Guevara |

Q.22 What democratic Polish trade union movement, led by Lech Walesa, challenged Communist single-party rule in the 1980s?

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|-----------------|------------------------------|
| (A) Bolsheviks | (B) Solidarity (Solidarność) |
| (C) Labor Front | (D) Red Army |

Q.23 A democratic ethos applies not only to state governments but also to:

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|--|---------------------------------------|
| (A) Families, classrooms, workplaces, and local community associations | (B) Outer space exploration only |
| (C) Ancient museum paintings only | (D) Military battlefields exclusively |

Q.24 Can a democracy eliminate all social differences and ensure total unanimity on every issue?

- (A) Yes, democracy brainwashes everyone to think identically (B) No, but it provides a peaceful institutional framework to negotiate and accommodate differing viewpoints
- (C) Yes, by jailing anyone who has a differing opinion (D) Democracy does not care about social differences

Q.25 The fundamental moral virtue of democracy is that it enhances the:

- (A) Power of kings (B) Dignity, moral equality, and self-respect of individual citizens
- (C) Wealth of military generals (D) Secrecy of government files

CBSE CANDIDATE OMR ANSWER RESPONSE GRID (SET F)

01	(A) (B) (C) (D)	02	(A) (B) (C) (D)	03	(A) (B) (C) (D)	04	(A) (B) (C) (D)	05	(A) (B) (C) (D)
06	(A) (B) (C) (D)	07	(A) (B) (C) (D)	08	(A) (B) (C) (D)	09	(A) (B) (C) (D)	10	(A) (B) (C) (D)
11	(A) (B) (C) (D)	12	(A) (B) (C) (D)	13	(A) (B) (C) (D)	14	(A) (B) (C) (D)	15	(A) (B) (C) (D)
16	(A) (B) (C) (D)	17	(A) (B) (C) (D)	18	(A) (B) (C) (D)	19	(A) (B) (C) (D)	20	(A) (B) (C) (D)
21	(A) (B) (C) (D)	22	(A) (B) (C) (D)	23	(A) (B) (C) (D)	24	(A) (B) (C) (D)	25	(A) (B) (C) (D)

Total Questions Attempted: ____ / 25

Marks Obtained: ____ / 25

Evaluator's Signature: _____

OFFICIAL ANSWER KEY & RAPID RECALL EXPLANATIONS (SET F)

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Concept & Rapid Recall Analysis
Q.1	(B)	Abraham Lincoln delivered this famous definition in his historic Gettysburg Address in 1863.
Q.2	(B)	In a democracy, political sovereignty resides with citizens who elect representatives through free, competitive votes.
Q.3	(B)	The PRI held power for 71 consecutive years through state patronage, co-optation, and electoral malpractices.
Q.4	(B)	General Pervez Musharraf overthrew Nawaz Sharif's elected government in 1999 and subordinated parliament in 2002.
Q.5	(B)	In China, candidates contesting the National People's Congress must be approved by the Chinese Communist Party.
Q.6	(B)	Saudi women were disenfranchised from participating in elections until municipal votes in 2015.
Q.7	(B)	Fiji's electoral system assigned greater voting weight to indigenous Fijians over Indo-Fijians, violating equal franchise.
Q.8	(B)	Political equality demands that every citizen's vote carries identical weight regardless of wealth or status.
Q.9	(B)	Robert Mugabe ruled Zimbabwe from independence in 1980 until 2017, harassing opponents and defying courts.
Q.10	(B)	Sen demonstrated that free media, opposition parties, and electoral vulnerability prevent democratic governments from ignoring famines.
Q.11	(B)	Critics note that democratic deliberations can delay rapid decisions and competitive politics can induce instability.
Q.12	(B)	Democracy excels in accommodating diverse social groups peacefully and self-correcting through public scrutiny and elections.
Q.13	(B)	Direct democracy involves citizens voting directly on laws (as in ancient Athens or Swiss cantonal Landsgemeinde).
Q.14	(A)	Massive demographic populations require representative governance where citizens elect specialized lawmakers.
Q.15	(B)	Dr. Ambedkar warned that personal hero-worship in politics is a certain road to degradation and dictatorship.
Q.16	(D)	Article 32 empowers citizens to move the Supreme Court directly to enforce Fundamental Rights, giving legal reality to democracy.
Q.17	(B)	Constitutional democracy ensures that even an elected majority must rule within constitutional laws and judicial limits.
Q.18	(B)	Estonia's post-Soviet citizenship laws made it difficult for Russian-speaking residents to obtain citizenship and voting franchise.
Q.19	(B)	Switzerland is renowned for combining representative structures with frequent direct-democratic citizen referendums.
Q.20	(B)	Constitutional fundamental rights protect minority liberties against majoritarian legislative overreach.
Q.21	(A)	General Augusto Pinochet overthrew the democratically elected government of Salvador Allende in a 1973 coup.

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Concept & Rapid Recall Analysis
Q.22	(B)	The Solidarity trade union led Poland's peaceful transition from one-party authoritarian rule to democracy.
Q.23	(A)	Democracy is both a political system and a social value emphasizing consultative, respectful decision-making in daily life.
Q.24	(B)	Differences are natural in human societies; democracy provides an institutional method to negotiate differences peacefully.
Q.25	(B)	Democracy affirms that every citizen holds equal moral worth and sovereign dignity in the political community.